

WHITE PAPER · SAMSUNG SL-65A/3200 × OIL & GAS

Samsung SL-65A for Oil & Gas

Large-envelope CNC lathe with steady-rest support for precision turning of long, heavy structural round parts. This paper covers what the machine does, the oil & gas parts we produce with it, the alloys we run, the tolerances and finishes oil & gas buyers expect, and the documentation package.

22" OD × 119" L max turning (with steady rest)
ENVELOPE

±0.0005" routine on critical features
TOLERANCE

1994
SINCE

Same-week / rig-down direct
RESPONSE



Big Thicket Express · 22" OD × 119" L max turning (with steady rest) · large-envelope heavy-duty CNC lathe with steady rest

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Executive summary

Machine: Samsung SL-65A/3200 (shop nickname: *Big Thicket Express*). large-envelope heavy-duty CNC lathe with steady rest at B&R Productions, running from our New Waverly, Texas shop.

Application: Large-envelope CNC lathe with steady-rest support for precision turning of long, heavy structural round parts for Oil & Gas customers — Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, subsea equipment vendors, produced-water handling equipment suppliers.

Envelope: 22" OD × 119" L max turning (with steady rest). **Tolerance:** ±0.0005" routine on critical features.

Traceability: Material by heat and lot on every job.

The machine, in context

This is the heaviest machine on the floor. When a customer sends a 20-inch forged blank and wants it turned to a finished OD with concentric internal features across ten feet of length, Big Thicket Express is the answer. The included steady rest is what makes long slender work possible — without it, deflection eats your tolerance.

Why Big Thicket Express for Oil & Gas work

The oilfield's large-diameter work — big valve bodies, large flanged components, heavy forged rounds — runs into a ceiling at most job shops somewhere around 16 to 18 inches. Big Thicket Express takes 22" OD at up to 119" with steady-rest support, which covers the parts that come back from other shops marked too large.

What this looks like on a real part

A large forged round that's both heavy and long is the case where swing alone doesn't help you. Unsupported, the part deflects under tool pressure and chatters, and the finish tells on you immediately. The steady rest carries the middle so the cut stays stable end to end — but only if the rest is set on a journal that's been turned true first. Clamp a steady rest onto as-received forged stock and you've just transferred the forging's runout into your finished diameter.

When this is the wrong machine

No through-bore worth mentioning. Long tubular oilfield stock that wants feeding through the spindle goes to Texaco Thunder even when the diameter would fit here — the 10-inch bore is the whole reason that machine exists.

Full specifications

Model	Samsung SL-65A/3200 ("Big Thicket Express")
Type	Large-envelope heavy-duty CNC turning center — Samsung SL-65A platform
Max turning capacity	22" OD × 119" L (B&R working spec, with steady rest)
Platform max swing	40.5" over bed
Platform max turning length	126" (3,200 mm) between centers
Chuck	24" hydraulic 3-jaw
Steady rest	Included — supports long slender work to hold straightness
Main motor	60 HP high-torque
Rigidity	Samsung SL-65 platform — heavy cast base for the largest oilfield turning work
Tolerance capability	±0.0005" routine on critical features; straightness held with steady-rest
Materials	Full range — forgings, bar stock, tubing in oilfield and structural alloys

Values marked "platform" reflect the machine manufacturer's published spec range for this platform family; B&R's working spec is what we quote on this specific unit.

Who this serves in Oil & Gas

Typical buyer: Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, subsea equipment vendors, produced-water handling equipment suppliers.

What's hard about oil & gas work: Chloride stress-corrosion cracking, sour service (H₂S), high-cycle pressure loading, exotic superalloys, and rig-down clocks that turn every hour into money. Documentation trails required for API-adjacent work.

Typical Oil & Gas parts we produce on Big Thicket Express

- Largest-diameter oilfield turned work (up to 22" OD)
- Long forged shafts finished to size
- Large wellhead spools requiring 22"-class turning
- Extended structural rods with steady-rest support
- Heavy oilfield structural components at 20"+ diameter

Above list is representative; if your part isn't shown, call and ask — most oilfield / aerospace / defense / industrial turned or milled work fits somewhere in the shop.

Alloys we run for Oil & Gas

Standard range: Inconel 718 (aged and annealed) · Inconel 625 · Super Duplex 2507 (UNS S32750) · Duplex 2205 · 17-4 PH (all conditions H900 to H1150) · Monel K-500 · Nitronic 50/60 · F22 · F91 · 4130/4140.

Alloy behavior is different in oilfield service. Inconel 718 in the aged condition (H900, roughly 40-45 HRC) is a different machining problem than annealed 718 — feeds, speeds, and tool geometry all shift. Super Duplex 2507 machined without cutting-temperature control develops brittle intermetallics that destroy the chloride-resistance the alloy was chosen for; a shop that shrugs when you ask about phase balance is a shop that will quietly ruin your part. 17-4 PH in Condition A machines like a well-behaved stainless; in H900 it's a different animal. Every one of these alloys we run weekly, not experimentally.

What "we run these weekly" means: we stock or reliably source the common alloys in the industry's typical spec range. Sharp tooling, proven feeds and speeds, and process control specific to each alloy family. Your part is not the one we're experimenting on.

How we machine it — our 5-step process

This is the process B&R runs on every job, oil & gas or otherwise. The specifics of feeds, speeds, and tooling shift by alloy and machine; the discipline is universal.

- 1 Material verification.** Every job starts with material traceability. Heat and lot numbers documented against the mill test report. For customer-supplied material, we verify against the CofC before touching the stock.
- 2 First-article layout.** Stock is measured and laid out before any cutting starts. Concentricity, roundness, and squareness of the starting material established; if the stock is out of tolerance we call the customer before wasting time on a bad blank.
- 3 Roughing with process control for the alloy.** Feeds, speeds, and coolant strategy set for the specific alloy family — sharp coated carbide (or PCD for high-volume Ti Grade 5), positive rake, high-pressure through-tool coolant on 2507 and Inconel to control cutting temperature. Interrupted cuts get extra attention because they cycle heat into the workpiece.
- 4 Finish pass to spec.** Finish pass with a fresh insert, controlled DOC, and measured surface-finish targets. Critical features (bore concentricity, seat grooves, sealing surfaces) are held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer.
- 5 CMM verification + documentation.** Every critical dimension CMM-verified. First-article report generated. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery. If your quality group needs a documentation package beyond that, tell us with the RFQ and we'll be straight about what we can and can't produce in-house.

Tolerance and finish expectations in Oil & Gas

±0.0005" routine on critical sealing and mating surfaces. Bore concentricity and roundness held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer. Surface-finish targets measured with a profilometer, not estimated. For seat grooves and packing bores, finish is often the difference between a sealing part and a leak-path.

Documentation and quality workflow

Material traceability by heat and lot on every job — non-negotiable for API-adjacent work. First-article layout and CMM verification standard. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery. If your quality group needs a documentation package beyond that, send us the requirement with the RFQ and we'll tell you straight whether we can meet it in-house or whether you need a shop with a formal QMS registration.

Response time and emergency work

Rig-down and fleet-down work prioritized over routine production. Same-day and next-day realistic when material is on the shelf. Call (936) 291-7827 direct — say "rig-down" and the phone gets to the shop floor. For emergency work off-hours, leave a voicemail; we route emergencies.

How we compare

Compared to buying finished components from an OEM: we're faster for one-offs and low-volume runs, and we hold traceability the OEM often won't share when you're outside their warranty window. Compared to a commodity job shop: we run the alloys weekly and won't ruin your metallurgy on cutting-temperature mistakes.

Working with B&R Productions

New customer or existing, the process starts the same way: call (936) 291-7827 or send a print through the quote form. Prints are accepted as PDF, STEP, IGES, DWG, or DXF; if you only have a sample part, we reverse-engineer routinely. NDAs on request, and prints stay in-shop rather than going out to third-party vendors. Note for defense and aerospace buyers: B&R is not ITAR- or AS9100-registered, so export-controlled prints and AS9100 flow-down programs need a registered shop — we'll tell you that on the first call, not after the PO.

Quotes typically come back within 24 hours for standard work, same-day for repeat customers on stocked materials, and near-immediately by phone for emergency and rig-down situations. Lead times are quoted honestly — we don't promise Wednesday and deliver next month.

Frequently asked questions

8 questions covering the Samsung SL-65A platform and Oil & Gas work. Also indexed as FAQ schema for AI answer engines.

What's the Samsung SL-65A's max turning capacity?

22" OD × 119" L is B&R's working spec (with steady rest). The platform max is 40.5" swing over bed × 126" (3,200 mm) between centers. This is the heaviest machine on our floor.

Does the SL-65A include a steady rest?

Yes. The steady rest is what makes long slender turning work possible on this envelope — without it, deflection eats your tolerance on any part longer than about 30 diameters.

What's the horsepower and chuck size?

60 HP high-torque main motor with a 24" hydraulic 3-jaw chuck. Heavy cast base for the largest oilfield turning work we take.

What kind of oil & gas customers does B&R Productions work with?

Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, and subsea equipment vendors. We work with new customers regularly — first-time orders don't get worse service.

Do you handle rig-down and emergency work?

Yes. Same-day and next-day are realistic when the material is on the shelf (Inconel 718, 625, Super Duplex 2507, 17-4 PH, 4140/4340). Call (936) 291-7827 direct and say "rig-down" — the phone gets to the shop floor, not a form.

Do you machine to API 6A / API 6D tolerances?

Yes — API-adjacent tolerances are routine, and material traceability by heat and lot is standard on every job. Worth being precise about the wording, though: we machine to the tolerances and finishes those specs call for, but B&R is not an API-licensed facility. If your buyer requires parts from an API-licensed shop with a monogram, that's a different vendor. If they require parts machined to print at API-class tolerances with full traceability, that's us.

How do you keep Super Duplex 2507 from losing its chloride resistance during machining?

Controlled cutting temperature — moderate SFM, aggressive feed with sharp coated carbide, high-pressure through-tool coolant. The failure mode nobody wants (sigma-phase intermetallics forming from overheating) shows up months later in service. We run 2507 weekly — this is a process we've internalized, not a spec we're learning on your part.

Can you reverse-engineer discontinued OEM oilfield parts?

Yes — routine work. Send a worn sample and any print or spec you have. We produce the replacement with material traceability the OEM often won't share when you're outside their warranty window.

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Ready to talk about your Oil & Gas work?

Send us a print or a sample photo and specs. Emergencies: call direct and say "rig-down."

Published by B&R Productions — a precision CNC machining shop in New Waverly, Texas, in business since 1994. Serving oil & gas, aerospace, defense, and industrial customers across Texas and the Gulf Coast.

Written by the B&R Productions team. Machine specs verified against manufacturer data. Alloy and process notes reflect shop practice as of 2026-01-15.